



“Open source professionals should be self-driven and objective about criticism”

If you are willing to get into a career in open source technology, there are some 'additional' attributes that you require apart from your technical expertise.

Diksha P Gupta spoke to Sreehari S, managing director, Novell India (The Attachmate Group), about what qualities are required for a successful open source professional and the company's plans in India. Read on...

Sreehari S, managing director, Novell India, (The Attachmate Group)

Q Do you feel that India is rich in open source skills?

A If you talk about the market, it surely is growing and so is the interest of people in making a career with open source technology. With the cost advantage, and more and more customers not wanting to get locked down by specific vendors, people are increasingly evaluating open source solutions. Along with that, the interest amongst professionals is growing. We see a lot of traction amongst the students as well, when we go for campus interviews. More and more professionals now want to work in this area.

Q Is that one of the reasons why Attachmate is banking big on the Indian market?

A India is definitely a big market for Attachmate. We have a lot of commitment to the India development centre because of the value it provides. Our investments, of course, keep shifting from location to location, depending on the projects, like in any other company. But broadly, there is a greater commitment to the Indian development centre and it is growing significantly.

Q Can you throw some light on what kind of growth you have had in the India development centre over the last year?

A We have grown about 15-20 per cent in headcount and we see ourselves growing at the same pace next year too. This hiring includes candidates from colleges as well. Beyond the growth in numbers, our objective is also to grow in terms of value we provide. So we do not focus too much on numbers alone.

Q Do you think the education provided in Indian colleges is good enough to churn out professionals in the open source technology domain?

A I think industry is plugging into the education system so that we get better and much more employable talent. That is the general phenomenon and open source companies are not far behind. Industry is investing and influencing the education system on what kind of courses they ought to cover so that the talent being churned out is good enough to merge into the work place. We pick employees from colleges across India. We target some of the premier institutes across the country. Over the last several years, the trend is an increased penetration of open source talent